

Official Rules – Online Chess Season v9.6

Last updated: 11/5/2026

1. Platform & Schedule

- 1.1 The platform for the season is Chess.com – SPKC International Chess Club (club link as announced by the organiser).
- 1.2 All official season tournaments will be created inside this club.
- 1.3 The tournament time is every Sunday at 20:00.
- 1.4 Players should be online and ready at least 5 minutes before the start time.
- 1.5 The season dates are 26/4/2026 – 12/7/2026.
- 1.6 Rounds will start at the announced time. The organiser is not required to delay, restart, or remake a tournament for late players.
- 1.7 It is each player's responsibility to join the tournament lobby on Chess.com before the start time. Being online on Chess.com does not count as being joined in the tournament.
- 1.8 Exam Break: Official season tournaments will pause starting two weeks before the main school exam period and will resume after the exam period ends. The exact dates of the break will be announced in the WhatsApp group.
- 1.9 Late Join: Players should be in the tournament lobby before Round 1 starts. Players who join later using Chess.com's late-join feature are still eligible for Season Points, but receive no compensation for missed rounds; those rounds count as 0 points for Season totals.

2. Eligibility

- 2.1 Any student may join the SPKC International Chess Club on Chess.com, but only registered season players are allowed to play in official season tournaments.
- 2.2 Unregistered players must not join season tournaments. If an unregistered player somehow enters, their results will be removed and will not count for the event or the season.

2.3 Players who want to register for the season must apply through the tournament application WhatsApp group.

2.4 New players may apply to join the season in the middle of the season through the application group.

2.5 Applications must be submitted at least 4 days before the next round the player wants to join.

2.6 Acceptance of late applications is not guaranteed; the organiser may accept or reject a late application to keep the total number of season players suitable for the format, including keeping a reasonably balanced number of participants.

2.7 A player only starts scoring Season Points from the first round after their registration is officially accepted and announced.

3. Format

3.1 The format is Swiss.

3.2 Everyone plays all rounds according to the Chess.com Swiss system; the season is not a knock-out competition.

3.3 Each round is played as a separate Chess.com club tournament.

4. Time Controls

4.1 The time control cycle is Bullet → Blitz → Rapid → Bullet → ...

4.2 Each week's time control type is fixed by this cycle.

4.3 The exact time control for a given round will be announced in the group at least 1 day before the tournament.

5. Accounts & Identity

5.1 Each player must register one Chess.com account for the season.

5.2 All season games must be played using this registered account only.

5.3 Games played on any other (unregistered) account may be disqualified (DSQ) and not counted for the season.

5.4 Using multiple accounts to gain an advantage may result in removal from the

season.

6. Season Points

6.1 For each official round, Season Points are awarded according to final tournament place.

6.2 The points table is as follows:

- 1st: 25
- 2nd: 18
- 3rd: 15
- 4th: 12
- 5th: 10
- 6th: 8
- 7th: 6
- 8th: 4
- 9th: 2
- 10th: 1

7. Brilliant Move Bonus

7.1 Each Brilliant move “!!” shown in Chess.com Game Review for games in that tournament gives +4 Season Points.

7.2 Brilliants only count for games where the player’s final result is a win or a draw; Brilliants in games the player loses do not give bonus points.

7.3 Each game may be submitted for Brilliant Move bonuses only once; the first Game Review (screenshot or link) submitted for that game is final, and later reviews cannot be used to “fish” for more Brilliants by running deeper analysis.

7.4 Event Season Points for a player = place points under Rule 6 + 4 × number of eligible Brilliants in that tournament.

7.5 To claim Brilliant Move bonus points, a player must send either (a) a

screenshot of the Chess.com Game Review showing the Brilliant moves, or (b) the game link with Game Review enabled, to the organiser or designated WhatsApp group within 24 hours after the tournament ends.

7.6 If there is serious suspicion that a player used outside assistance mainly to obtain Brilliants or unusual accuracy, the organiser may review the games under Rule 15 (Cheating Investigations).

8. Tournament Standings

8.1 Final places, including all tiebreaks, are taken directly from the official Chess.com tournament standings.

8.2 Season Points are assigned based on those final places.

8.3 If two or more players finish on the same score (same match points), place order and corresponding place points are determined by Chess.com's official tiebreak system for that event (for example, Sonneborn-Berger or Buchholz). The organiser will not manually recalculate tiebreaks using other systems; the Chess.com final standings are binding.

8.4 Full-Point Byes: If a player receives an automatic full-point bye from Chess.com due to an odd number of participants, that point counts exactly like a normal win for tournament standings and Season Points.

8.5 Half-Point Byes: If Chess.com or the organiser allows requested half-point byes, these may count for the player's tournament score in that event but do not give Season Points unless the organiser explicitly announces otherwise before the round.

9. Cancelled Rounds & Attendance Bonus

9.1 A round is official only if at least 4 players join the tournament by the start time.

9.2 If fewer than 4 players join, the round is cancelled.

9.3 In a cancelled round, no normal tournament points under Rule 6 are awarded.

9.4 Each player who joined the cancelled tournament on time receives an

attendance bonus of 5 Season Points.

9.5 Players who did not join receive 0 points for that round.

9.6 In records or score sheets, the round may be marked CXL, and players who joined may be marked CXL/ATT (+5).

10. No-Shows, DNF, Planned Bye & Repeated Absence

10.1 A player who does not enter the tournament at all for a round is marked DNS (Did Not Start) and gets 0 points for that round.

10.2 A player who joins the tournament and starts playing, but does not complete the full event, is marked DNF (Did Not Finish) and gets 0 points for that round.

10.3 Examples of DNF include leaving the tournament early, withdrawing before all scheduled rounds are completed, or stopping play after starting the event so that the player does not finish the tournament.

10.4 A player may request 1 planned bye during the season by informing the organiser in advance, preferably at least 24 hours before the round.

10.5 A planned bye gives 0 points for that round, but it is not counted as an unexplained absence.

10.6 A player who has 2 consecutive rounds marked DNS or DNF without a valid reason may be removed from the season at the organiser's discretion.

10.7 Players who know they cannot play should inform the organiser in advance if possible.

10.8 Weekly Check-in: The organiser may require players to confirm their attendance in the WhatsApp group before each round. Check-in closes 60 minutes before the tournament start time. Players who do not check in by the deadline may be excluded from that round's tournament entry list and may be recorded as DNS for that round.

11. Season Champion

11.1 The Season Champion is the player with the highest total Season Points

after all rounds.

11.2 If there is a tie on total points, the following tiebreaks are used in order:

11.2.1 Most 1st-place finishes across the season.

11.2.2 Head-to-head, meaning the total score in all season games played between the tied players.

11.2.3 Playoff match, in a format decided by the organiser.

11.3 Participation Floor: To be eligible for the title of Season Champion or any final reward, a player must participate in at least 80% of the scheduled official rounds, rounded up to the next whole round.

12. Fair Play & Behaviour

12.1 No engines or outside assistance are allowed.

12.2 This includes computer engines, analysis tools, bots, help from other people, or using a second device or account to get hints.

12.3 All moves must be the player's own.

12.4 Players must be respectful in games, club chat, and private messages related to the season.

12.5 Friendly banter is allowed, but harassment, threats, offensive language, or repeated disruption are not allowed.

12.6 Serious or repeated misconduct may result in warnings, loss of points, disqualification from an event, or removal from the season.

12.7 Pre-arranged draws, match-fixing, or any agreement to intentionally manipulate the result of a game (including intentional ultra-short draws arranged in advance) are prohibited and may result in penalties, including 0 points for both players, disqualification from events, or removal from the season.

12.8 Early Draws: Short draws are allowed, but intentional draws before move 20 that are clearly arranged only to manipulate season standings are discouraged. If the organiser determines a draw was pre-arranged to influence Season Points, both players may receive 0 points for that game and may face further penalties

under this section.

13. Cheating Accusations

13.1 Players must not accuse others of cheating in public chat, club chat, group chat, or game chat.

13.2 If a player suspects cheating, they should privately message the organiser or use the Chess.com report system.

13.3 The organiser may review the matter and, if necessary, wait for Chess.com fair-play action before making a final decision.

13.4 False, repeated, or disruptive public accusations may be treated as misconduct.

14. Technical Issues

14.1 All games and results are governed by the Chess.com platform.

14.2 If a player disconnects, lags, crashes, or loses on time due to technical issues, the result shown by Chess.com will stand.

14.3 The organiser is not required to replay or change a game because of internet, device, or connection problems.

14.4 Players are responsible for their own internet and devices; technical issues are unfortunate but cannot be compensated.

14.5 No-Move Walkovers: If a player is paired in a round but makes no move at all and loses by abandonment, timeout, or another no-show result on Chess.com, the opponent keeps the official win shown by Chess.com, while the absent player is recorded as DNS for that round and may face Rule 10.6 if this forms part of repeated unexplained absence.

14.6 Mouse-Slips & Takebacks: Mouse-slips and mis-clicks are considered part of online play. Games will not be replayed or adjusted due to mouse-slips or requested takebacks.

14.7 Players are strongly advised to play on a stable connection (for example, home Wi-Fi or wired internet) rather than on the move or on unreliable networks.

14.8 Intentionally abusing disconnections or “lagging” on purpose to gain time or advantage is forbidden and may be treated as misconduct under Rule 12 or a fair-play matter under Rule 15.

15. Cheating Investigations

15.1 If Chess.com closes, restricts, or flags an account for fair-play reasons, the organiser may review that player’s results in the season.

15.2 If there is reasonable evidence of cheating or outside assistance, the organiser may:

15.2.1 Annul specific results.

15.2.2 Remove bonus points.

15.2.3 Disqualify the player from events.

15.2.4 Remove the player from the season.

15.3 Serious fair-play violations may lead to retroactive changes to standings if necessary.

15.4 If Chess.com later closes or bans an account for fair-play reasons after one or more season events, the organiser may remove that player from future events and wipe their Season Points from the leaderboard. Past tournament standings for other players will normally not be recalculated, except in very serious cases where the organiser decides that adjustments are necessary for fairness.

16. Spectators & Outside Advice

16.1 People who are not playing in a game must not give advice, analysis, or suggested moves to players during a round, whether in chat or in person.

17. Appeals

17.1 If a player believes a rule has been applied incorrectly, they may message the organiser within 24 hours of the round.

17.2 The organiser will review the situation and may confirm or adjust the decision.

17.3 After this review, the organiser's decision is final for this season.

18. Organiser Discretion & Uncovered Situations

18.1 For situations not specifically covered by these rules, the organiser may make a decision in good faith and apply it equally to all players.

18.2 New rules or clarifications apply from the moment they are announced and are not used to change past results, except in serious cases such as proven cheating or major fair-play violations.

19. Data & Privacy

19.1 By participating in the season, players agree that their Chess.com username, results, and season scores may be shared in the tournament WhatsApp group and in official standings records (such as spreadsheets or summary posts).

19.2 Players should avoid sharing personal information (such as phone number, address, or other sensitive data) in public chats connected to the tournaments.